AIKIA.WALLET / LAUNCH COSTING

Our own wallet, at break-even.

Launch on our own Google Wallet and Apple Wallet engines, with no PassKit, and every feature on. What it costs to run, what to charge so 3 to 5 cafes cover it, where the data lives, what runs by itself and how it stays secure. Prices checked 19 October 2026 at Rs 96 to the US dollar.

Rs 12,724

A MONTH to run everything, all features, for 3 or 5 cafes. Rs 1,52,682 a year.

Rs 2,606

A MONTH per cafe to break even with 5 cafes. With 3 cafes: Rs 4,344.

Rs 0

PER CUSTOMER. Google and Apple charge nothing per card, so 100 or 200 customers cost the same.

The answer. Charge **Rs 2,999 a month** per cafe (or Rs 29,999 a year) plus a one-time **Rs 4,999 setup**. 5 cafes cover every running cost from the first month. With 3 cafes, charge Rs 4,499 a month or accept a gap of about Rs 3,939 a month until cafe 5 joins.

How to read this. Planning numbers, not quotes. S = price found in a published source (re-check on the vendor page before paying). E = our estimate. Founder time and salaries are not costed. PassKit is used only for demos until launch and is left out.

1 / RUNNING COST

Everything we pay every month

Every feature is included: wallet cards, tiers, scan-and-charge, credit, gifts, geofencing, weather-mood and campaign messages, the ledger and backups. None of it grows with the number of customers at this size.

Service and what it does	Price basis	Src	Rs a month
Vercel Pro, 1 seat Runs the app and the scheduled jobs: join page, staff scanner, owner dashboard, guest pages, Apple pass web service. Hobby (free) is non-commercial only.	US$20 a month, usage credit included	S	Rs 1,920
Supabase Pro The database and ledger, logins, daily backups kept 7 days. Never pauses (the free plan pauses after 7 idle days).	US$25 a month	S	Rs 2,400
Apple Developer Program Our own Apple Wallet pass certificate and push updates to iPhones.	US$99 a year, shown per month	S	Rs 792
Weather data, commercial (Open-Meteo Standard) Weather-mood messages. The free API is for non-commercial use.	US$29 a month per Open-Meteo's own announcement; confirm	S	Rs 2,784
GitHub Team, 2 users Protected main branch and required reviews on our private code (not enforced on the free plan for private repositories).	about US$4 a user a month; confirm on github.com/pricing	S	Rs 768
GST at 18% on the imported services (US$90.25 a month)			Rs 1,560
Chartered accountant GST registration, monthly GST returns, invoices to cafes.	monthly retainer	E	Rs 2,500
Total a month			**Rs 12,724**
Total a year			**Rs 1,52,682**

Free at this size, and safe for business use

Service	What it does	Cost
Google Wallet API and Google Pay & Wallet Console	Issue and update Android cards, messages, nearby alerts.	Free, no per-card fee found
Apple push notifications (APNs)	Tells iPhones to fetch the updated card.	Free with the developer account
Login-link and alert email (Resend free)	3,000 emails a month, 100 a day. Enough for 5 cafes' teams and our alerts.	Free
GitHub Actions	Tests on every change, nightly backup, health checks every 10 minutes.	Free minutes cover this
Cloudflare R2 (off-site backup copy)	A second, encrypted copy of the database every night, kept 30 days.	Free up to 10 GB
Cloudflare DNS and protection	Domain records, DDoS shield, basic firewall in front of the app.	Free plan
Password manager (Bitwarden, 2 users)	All keys and passwords in one shared vault, never in chat or code.	Free for 2 users
Domain	wallet.aikia.world, a sub-domain of the agency's domain.	Rs 0 extra

2 / PER CAFE

Cost per cafe, for 3 to 5 cafes

Cafes x customers	Customers	Running cost a month	A year	Per cafe a month	Per customer a month
3 x 100	300	Rs 12,724	Rs 1,52,682	**Rs 4,241**	Rs 42
3 x 200	600	Rs 12,724	Rs 1,52,682	**Rs 4,241**	Rs 21
4 x 100	400	Rs 12,724	Rs 1,52,682	**Rs 3,181**	Rs 32
4 x 200	800	Rs 12,724	Rs 1,52,682	**Rs 3,181**	Rs 16
5 x 100	500	Rs 12,724	Rs 1,52,682	**Rs 2,545**	Rs 25
5 x 200	1000	Rs 12,724	Rs 1,52,682	**Rs 2,545**	Rs 13

What each feature costs us

Feature	What it runs on	Extra cost
Google Wallet cards, updates, tier colours	Google Wallet API	Rs 0
Apple Wallet cards and updates	Our pass certificate + Apple push	in the Apple fee
Geofencing (up to 10 locations a cafe)	Apple: our text on the lock screen. Google: nearby alert in Google's own words	Rs 0
Weather-mood messages	Daily weather check + card message	in the weather licence
Campaigns, offers, win-back messages	Card messages (Google: up to 3 a card a day)	Rs 0
Credit, scan-and-charge, pay codes, gifts	Our ledger in Supabase	Rs 0
Ledger, members, history, backups	Supabase Pro + nightly off-site copy	in Supabase
Optional later: WhatsApp messages	WhatsApp provider (not part of launch)	about Rs 0.12 a utility message

Costs that come per cafe, outside software

Item	When	Cost
QR standee and counter poster	Once	Rs 300 to 500
Payment fee when a cafe pays us by card (UPI is free)	Each payment	about 2.36%
Onboarding visit and staff training (about 2 hours)	Once	founder time

3 / BREAK-EVEN PRICE

What to charge so we are never in loss

Break-even here means the cafes' fees cover every running cost each month, after the card-payment fee. Founders are unpaid.

Cafes	Break-even price per cafe a month	Rounded price	A year, paid upfront
3	Rs 4,344	Rs 4,499	Rs 44,999
4	Rs 3,258	Rs 3,499	Rs 34,999
5	Rs 2,606	Rs 2,999	Rs 29,999

If we charge	Cafes needed to break even	Surplus with 5 cafes a month
Rs 1,999 a month	7	-Rs 2,964
Rs 2,499 a month	6	-Rs 523
Rs 2,999 a month	5	Rs 1,918
Rs 3,999 a month	4	Rs 6,800
Rs 4,499 a month	3	Rs 9,241

Our recommendation

- **Rs 2,999 a month per cafe** (Rs 29,999 a year upfront, two months free), all features included. That is about Rs 100 a day for the cafe.
- **Rs 4,999 one-time setup** per cafe: card design, tiers, staff training, standee. Every 5 paid setups (Rs 24,995) cover most of the one-time legal and set-up costs.
- **Founding-cafe offer for the first 3:** setup free, Rs 2,999 a month, in return for a case study. The gap of about Rs 3,939 a month closes when cafe 5 joins.
- Above 5 cafes everything is surplus: each new cafe adds about Rs 2,928 a month after fees, because running cost doesn't grow at this size.

4 / DATA

Where the data lives and what we keep

What	Where	Why
Members, tiers, ledger, credit, gifts, campaigns, team	Supabase Postgres (choose the Mumbai region)	One database with row-level security: each cafe sees only its own rows. The ledger is append-only, so every stamp, payment and refund stays on record.
Card artwork and logos	In the app's code (public/brand), served by Vercel	Fast, versioned, no extra storage cost.
Keys and certificates (Google service account, Apple pass certificate, database keys)	Vercel encrypted settings (type Secret) and the Bitwarden vault	Never in code, chat, email or screenshots.
Backups	Supabase daily backup (7 days) + our nightly encrypted copy in Cloudflare R2 (30 days)	Two places, two companies. A restore is tested once a month.
Code	Private GitHub repository SHXHMNS/aikia.wallet	Every change reviewed and tested before it goes live.

What we store about a guest, and what we don't

Stored	Never stored
Name, consent date, member code, visits, stamps, tier, credit balance, gift history	Phone number in the card or its QR, card or bank details, UPI IDs, location history

Size. 5 cafes x 200 customers = 1,000 members. A year of visits, payments and gifts is a few MB. Supabase Pro holds this many times over; data is not a cost until thousands of cafes.

DPDP Act. Guests consent on the join page. On request, a cafe owner or we delete a member and their card. Keep the privacy notice and a deletion log; the lawyer drafts both.

5 / AUTOMATION

What runs by itself, so nothing waits on us

Job	When	Runs on	If it fails
Test, type-check and build every code change	Every push	GitHub Actions	Change is blocked from going live
Deploy: preview first, then live	On merge to main	Vercel	One-click roll back to the last good version
Database changes (new columns, tables)	With the code change, after approval	Supabase migration step in the workflow	Applied to the staging copy first; the live app never runs ahead of its database
Retry wallet cards that failed to update	Daily (more often on Vercel Pro)	Vercel Cron	Alert email if any card stays out of sync
Weather check and mood messages; scheduled and win-back campaigns	Every morning, 9 am	Vercel Cron	Logged in "Recent sends"; never more than 3 Google messages a card a day
Expire unused gifts and return them to the sender	Daily	Vercel Cron	Logged
Off-site encrypted database backup	Nightly	GitHub Actions to Cloudflare R2	Alert email
Health check of the app, database and wallet engines	Every 10 minutes	GitHub Actions	Alert email to both founders
Dependency and security updates	Weekly	GitHub Dependabot	Pull request to review
Monthly cafe report: visits, members, credit loaded and spent	1st of the month	Vercel Cron + email	Logged

How we avoid lag and breakdowns

- **The counter never waits on Google or Apple.** The ledger is saved first. The wallet card updates right after, and if Google or Apple is slow, the daily retry finishes the job.
- **No double charges.** Every scan carries a one-time key, so a double tap or a weak network can't charge twice.
- **Fast for India.** Database in Mumbai; app served from Vercel's edge network.
- **Safe changes.** Staging first, automatic tests, preview link, then live. Roll back in one click.
- **Room to grow.** Vercel Pro and Supabase Pro comfortably carry 5 to 50 cafes before any upgrade.

6 / SECURITY

How the code, website and servers stay safe

Area	What we do	Cost
Accounts	Two-step login on Google, Apple, Vercel, Supabase, GitHub, Cloudflare and the domain registrar. Only the two founders are owners.	Rs 0
Keys and certificates	Stored only as Vercel Secrets and in Bitwarden. Google key and Apple certificate rotated once a year. Never in code or chat.	Rs 0
Code	Private repository, protected main branch, review before merge, Dependabot alerts, no secrets in the repository.	GitHub Team
Database	Row-level security per cafe; staff can scan but not see the member list; owner-only reversals; append-only ledger.	Rs 0
App	HTTPS only, security headers and content policy, rate limits on sign-up, single-use pay codes, scan-only limit and daily cap on credit.	Rs 0
Network	Vercel's built-in DDoS protection; Cloudflare in front of the domain.	Rs 0
Backups	Two copies in two companies, encrypted, restore tested monthly.	Rs 0
Outside test (later)	Professional penetration test once we pass about 10 cafes or before any chain.	about Rs 1 to 1.5 lakh, once (E)

Before the first real customer. Turn on two-step login everywhere (Vercel asked for it on 18 October and it was skipped), mark every Vercel setting as Secret, and delete the old Google key file from Downloads.

7 / ONE-TIME AND BUILD

What we pay once, and the build that is left

One-time item	Src	Cost
Lawyer: cafe agreement, privacy notice (DPDP Act), programme terms	E	Rs 25,000 to Rs 60,000
CA: GST registration and set-up	E	Rs 2,000 to Rs 5,000
Trademark filing for aikia.wallet, 1 class, e-filing (government fee)	S	Rs 4,500
QR standee and counter poster, 5 cafes	E	Rs 1,500 to Rs 2,500
Test iPhone (second-hand) if no one in the team has one	E	Rs 0 to Rs 25,000
Total before launch		**Rs 33,000 to Rs 97,000**
Lawyer: written opinion on venue-only prepaid credit (before real money)	E	Rs 50,000 to Rs 1,00,000

Build left before launch on our own engines

Work	When	Effort
Apple Wallet engine: build and sign passes, Apple's update web service, push to iPhones	Before launch	12 days
Switch to our Google engine (already built), finish publishing approval, move cards	Before launch	3 days
Geofence and weather on own engines: Apple lock-screen text, Google nearby + message	Before launch	2 days
Notification budget: never more than 3 messages a card a day on Google	Before launch	1 days
Remove PassKit from settings and code paths	Before launch	1 days
Automation: nightly off-site backup, health checks, alert emails	Before launch	2 days
Staging copy and safe database-change workflow	Before launch	2 days
Security review and fixes	Before launch	5 days
Own email sender and domain	Before launch	1 days
Testing on real Android and iPhone at a cafe counter	Before launch	4 days
Online top-up through the cafe's own Razorpay / UPI account (optional)	Later	15 days

Who builds it	Before launch (33 days)	With online top-up (48 days)
Us, with Claude	Rs 0 extra cash	Rs 0 extra cash
Partner company at about Rs 70,000 a person-month (assumption; ask them to quote)	Rs 1,10,000	Rs 1,60,000

The money to keep aside, and the order of work

Budget line	Amount
Running cost, a month	Rs 12,724
Running cost, a year	Rs 1,52,682
One-time before launch	Rs 33,000 to Rs 97,000
Contingency 15% on running cost	Rs 22,902
Year one to keep aside (before any cafe pays)	**Rs 1,85,682 to Rs 2,72,585**
Year one income at 5 cafes x Rs 2,999 a month + Rs 4,999 setup, after card fees	Rs 2,00,099

When	What we do	Monthly cost
Weeks 0 to 2	Enrol in Apple Developer. Finish the Google business profile and request publishing access. Lawyer drafts agreement and privacy notice. CA registers GST. Keep demoing on PassKit's free draft cards.	about Rs 935
Weeks 2 to 5	Build the Apple engine, switch to our Google engine, automation, security review, test on real phones. Sign 3 founding cafes.	about Rs 935
Week 5	Launch: Vercel Pro, Supabase Pro, GitHub Team, weather licence on. Cancel PassKit. Onboard the first 3 cafes.	Rs 12,724
Months 2 to 3	Cafes 4 and 5 at Rs 2,999 a month. Break-even reached.	Rs 12,724
Months 4 to 6	Fix pricing with real data, 2 case studies, then 10 to 25 cafes. Penetration test past 10 cafes.	Rs 12,724

Sources (checked 19 Oct 2026)

- Google Wallet push and nearby notifications, 3 a card a day: developers.google.com/wallet/retail/loyalty-cards/use-cases/trigger-push-notifications
- Vercel Pro US$20 a seat, Hobby non-commercial: makerkit.dev/blog/saas/vercel-cost; community.vercel.com
- Supabase Pro US$25, daily backups 7 days, PITR US$100 extra: supabase.com/pricing; jetadmin.io Supabase pricing guide 2026
- Open-Meteo commercial plans: openmeteo.substack.com/p/api-subscriptions-for-commercial
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